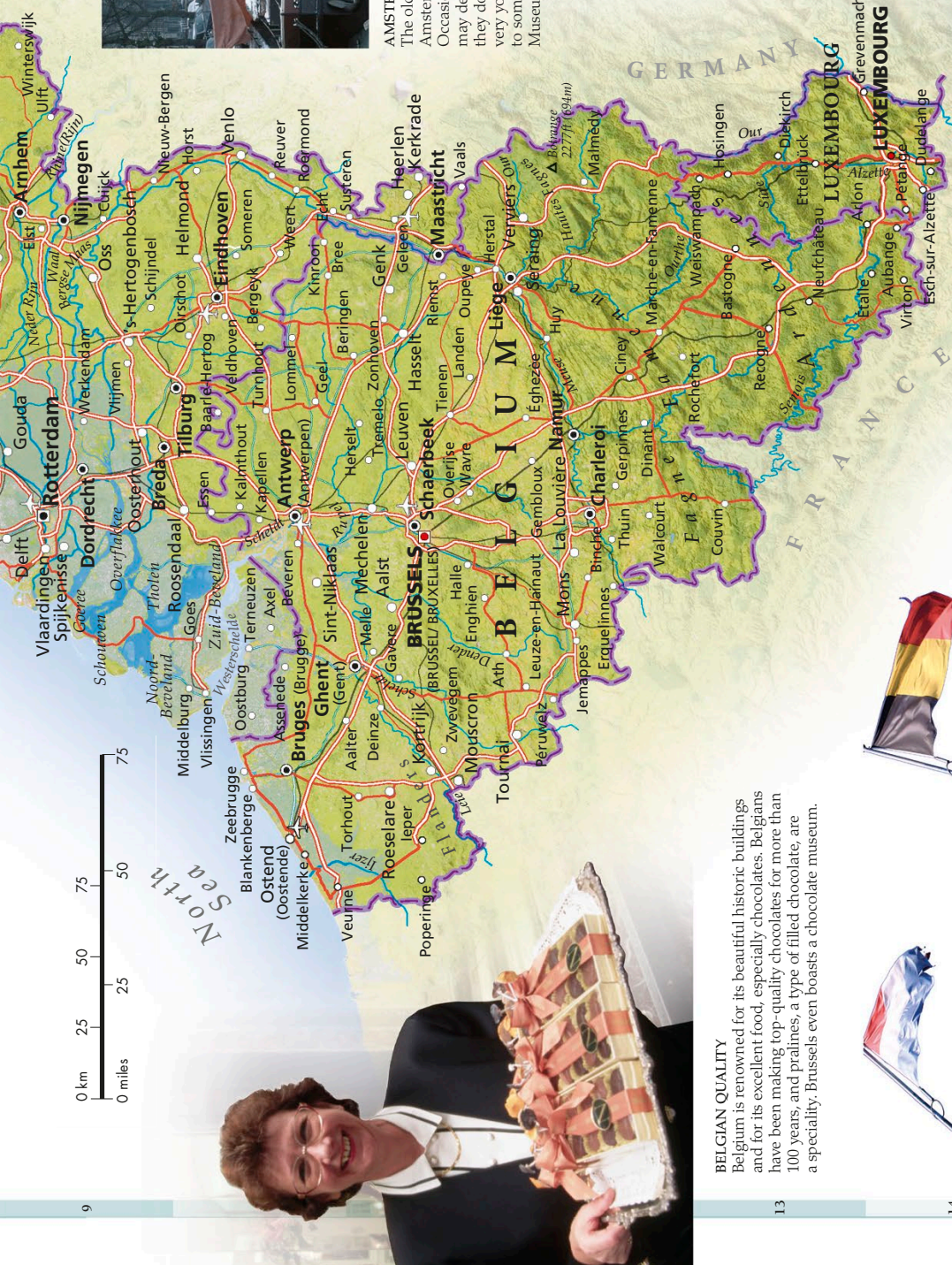
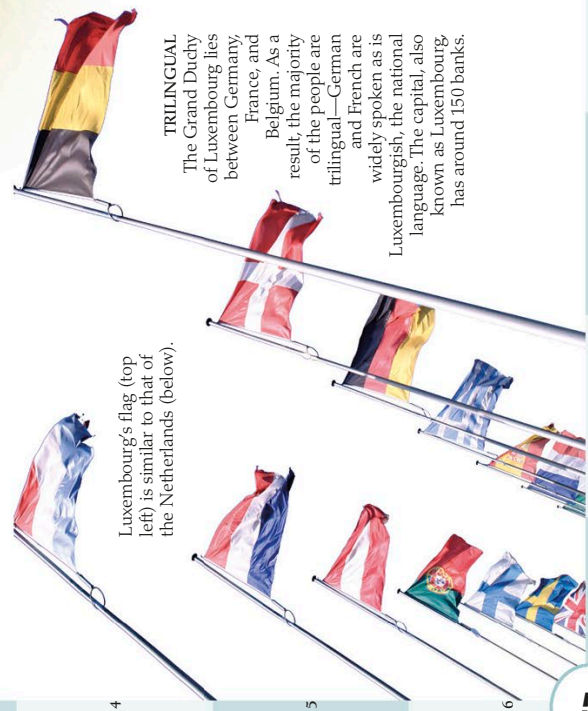


9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16



BELGIAN QUALITY

Belgium is renowned for its beautiful historic buildings and for its excellent food, especially chocolates. Belgians have been making top-quality chocolates for more than 100 years, and pralines, a type of filled chocolate, are a speciality. Brussels even boasts a chocolate museum.

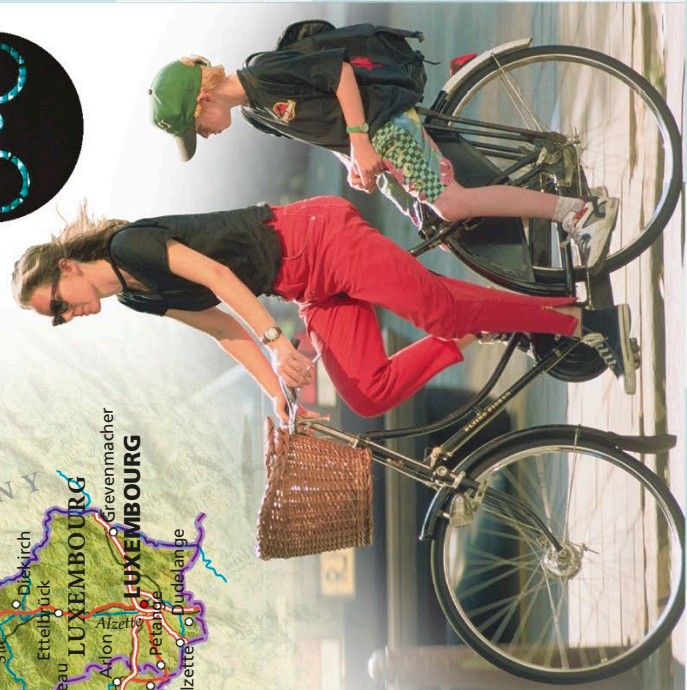


TRILINGUAL

The Grand Duchy of Luxembourg lies between Germany, France, and Belgium. As a result, the majority of the people are trilingual—German and French are widely spoken as is Luxembourgish, the national language. The capital, also known as Luxembourg, has around 150 banks.

Luxembourg's flag (top left) is similar to that of the Netherlands (below).

CYCLING
The flatness of the land makes the Netherlands ideal for cycling, and more than half a million people cycle to school or work each day. Lines of 20–100 children cycling together to school are common. Most of the roads have special cycle lanes, and bicycles are often the quickest form of transportation to get around the crowded towns and cities. The use of bicycles also reduces car use and thus cuts down the amount of air pollution.



Cyclists have their own traffic lights – this one is green for “go”.



AMSTERDAM, NETHERLANDS

The old architecture and picturesque canals make Amsterdam one of the most visited cities in Europe. Occasionally the canals freeze over and city officials may decide it's safe for people to go skating. When they do, men and women of all ages, from very old to very young, take to the ice. Amsterdam is also home to some great museums, including the Van Gogh Museum, Rijksmuseum, and the Anne Frank House.